B2 - Written Mediation 2: Teacher's Notes

A Music Festival

Before starting the mediation activity, ask students to read the task and the poster carefully to make the aim of the activity clear.

Your American friend, Kerry, is going to a festival in Spain in the summer. You went there the previous year and had a great time. You want to give Kerry some advice on the festival, for example, you know that there is a restaurant in the nearby village with good food at low prices, but there is no hotel there. You have also seen this poster about the festival.

Write an e-mail to your friend (about 150 words) giving him advice on accommodation, food, clothes and any other things you think would be helpful.



In written mediation, you need to refer to the document you have been asked to read. You cannot copy from it. Instead, paraphrase the ideas there in an informal way.

"QUICK TIPS"

Make sure you include all the aspects your friend needs to know in your e-mail. And do not forget the structure of an informal e-mail.

Let's get ready!

In this section, you will help students to get ready for the task. First of all, they will learn what to do (Analyse the task) and later, they will work on the information (Analyse the information). You can give them the Learning Sequence worksheet to work on.

1. Analyse the task

Tell students they are going to think about the receiver of the message, the reason for the message and the information included. This will help them to use the proper register (formal or informal).

Read the task carefully and answer these questions. They will help you choose the register of the mediation task.

a) Who is the receiver of the message? your American friend Kevin

b) Why are you going to send him a message? To give him advice on accommodation, food, etc.

c) What are you going to write? an e-mail.

2. Analyse the information

Now tell students to think about the relevant information on the poster they will have to use.

Read the information in the poster carefully.

a) Make a list of things you have to include in your e-mail.

b) Organise the ideas in a logical way. Write down the order. Use the chart below.

Things to include	Order
Your experience at the festival	1
Food	5
Accommodation	4
Clothes	6
Merchandising	7
Temperature	3
Dates	2

Let's prepare the language!

In this section, students will learn structures and language suitable for the task.

1. An informal e-mail

1. Read this e-mail where a person is giving advice to a friend who wants to learn Spanish. Do not pay attention to the missing words. Pay attention to the following aspects and answer the given questions:

   a) What's the style, tone and register? friendly and informal

   b) Does the introduction set the tone and present the aim of the e-mail? Yes, he acknowledges a previous e-mail in a friendly way and gives the purpose of this e-mail.

   c) Does the main paragraph include more than one piece of advice and are the structures used are varied? Yes, there are a variety of ways of giving advice.

   d) How does the e-mail end? with a friendly and natural farewell

Hi Sue,

Good to hear from you! I'm great, but I'm pretty busy at the moment because it's the end of the term and as you can imagine … I've got lots of exams! I'm really happy that you'd like to learn Spanish, so let me give you some advice.

I think the first thing you (1) ….. do is to look on the Internet for some free Spanish videos for beginners. You (2) ….. also look for free language activities. Getting a good dictionary – one with examples as well as meanings – is also (3) ….. . You need practice. So, if I were you, I (4) ….. write all the new words that you learn on flashcards that you could use to "test" yourself. If you have time to watch some films or series, watching them in Spanish, maybe with Spanish subtitles if you need them, (5) ….. your listening skills. Finally, (6) ….. listen to Spanish music? There are some great songs that you might like. Can you understand Rosalia? Well, you can try!

If you follow some of these tips, I'm sure your Spanish will improve a lot. Good luck!

Chris

2. Give advice and suggestions

1. Read the e-mail again and choose the correct answer.

1.	a) should	b) would	c) will
2.	a) could	b) try	c) have
3.	a) fun	b) great issue	c) a good idea
4.	a) will	b) should	c) would
5.	a) could	b) will help with	c) can need
6.	a) why don't you	b) what if	c) helps

Other Useful Language

What I would do is …
Why don't you …?
Have you tried …?
… will help with …
If I were you, I'd …
I'm not too sure about that.
Perhaps you could try …
How about …?

Do not use the same expressions all the time. It is important to vary the language to show you have a good vocabulary.



2. Complete these mini-dialogues by giving some advice.

   a) Speaker 1: I can't cook. I follow the recipe but it's never great. I give up!
   Speaker 2: Well, why don't you take cooking lessons?
   Speaker 1: Hmm, that's actually a good idea.

   b) Speaker 1: I need to buy a present for Julia, but I've no idea what she likes!
   Speaker 2: How about talking to her brother? He might have some ideas.
   Speaker 1: Perfect! Thanks.

   c) Speaker 1: I can't sleep well, so I have no energy in the morning.
   Speaker 2: If I were you, I wouldn't use my mobile phone before going to bed.
   Speaker 1: Great, thanks. I'll try.

Let's mediate!

Make sure students understand the task and you can summarise the tips below.

Your American friend, Kerry, is going to a festival in Spain in the summer. You went there the previous year and had a great time. You want to give Kerry some advice on the festival, for example, you know that there is a restaurant in the nearby village with good food at low prices, but there is no hotel there. You have also seen this poster about the festival.

Write an e-mail to your friend (about 150 words) giving him advice on accommodation, food, clothes and any other things you think would be helpful.

1. Content

Content

Look at the instructions and the poster and read the information there carefully again. Select the information you are going to tell your friend. You can use the following questions:

- Is it better to eat in the festival canteen or in the restaurant in the village? Why or why not?
- How does temperature affect your choices?
- Which tips will help your friend enjoy the festival?

2. Language

Language

Use your own words. Simplify or paraphrase the information.

Remember to adapt your language (register, style) to the task and addressee.

Vary the language you use. Look at the Other Useful Language on page 3.

Refer students to the task again and tell them to pay special attention to the Quick Tip. Make sure that the students read the rubric, so that they know what is important.

Let's evaluate!

Rubrics for assessment

Written Mediation

	Excellent	Good	Acceptable	Unsuitable
Clarity	The information is clear and easy to follow.The main points are emphasised.	The information is clear to follow but sometimes it is not easy to understand what the main points are.	The information selected is not relevant, lacks coherence and may include contradictions.	The information selected is not relevant, not clear, not easy to follow and includes contradictions.
Relevancy and processing	The student has summarised and paraphrased the main ideas without copying literally. No information has been added.	The student has summarised the main ideas but has not paraphrased them. No information has been added.	The student conveys some appropriate information by summarising the main ideas, but not all.	The student doesn't convey much appropriate information or has copied it from the text. Extra information may have been added.
Genre and organisation	The text follows the conventions of the specific text type, addressing it appropriately to the specific audience.	The text follows the conventions of the specific text type, but it is not addressed appropriately to the specific audience.	The text follows the conventions of the specific text type to a certain extent but the degree of formality is not correct.	The text does not follow the conventions of the specific text type, or it is not addressed appropriately to the specific audience.
Cohesion and organisation	The written text is logically organised, connected and cohesive. The text is organised in paragraphs, which have a key sentence. A wide range of connectors and linkers is used.	The written text is logically organised, connected and cohesive. The text is organised in paragraphs, which mostly have a key sentence. Basic connectors and linkers are correctly used.	The written text is organised, connected and cohesive. The text is organised in paragraphs but they do not have key sentences. A few basic connectors and linkers are correctly used.	The written text is not logically organised. Some parts are not coherent. Paragraphs seem to have no connection. Some basic connectors and linkers are used but not all correctly.
Vocabulary	The student uses a wide rage of appropriate vocabulary. Spelling is correct.	The student mostly uses appropriate and varied vocabulary. Spelling is correct.	The student uses appropriate vocabulary but it is not varied. There are some spelling mistakes but they do not impede comprehension.	The student doesn't use varied vocabulary or is not able to paraphrase. There are many spelling mistakes.
Grammar	The student uses a wide range of correct grammatical structures.	The student uses a wide range of grammatical structures but not always correctly.	The student uses basic but correct grammatical structures.	The student uses basic grammatical structures but not always correctly.